Ford Motor Company

Date

Sample, Sample A.
123 Anywhere Street
Anytown, USA 12335-6667

Your Vehicle: 1999 Sample Vehicle
Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

Firestone Wilderness AT Tire Program

Ford Motor Company has decided to replace all Firestone Wilderness AT tires (15-,16- and 17-inch) on Ford Motor Company products as a precautionary measure aimed at preventing potential tire failures from occurring in the future. The likelihood of tire failure in the near term is very low for owners of vehicles with newer tires. Our records indicate that your vehicle may have Firestone Wilderness AT tires as either original equipment or replacement tires.

Why we are replacing these tires.

This replacement program is both a voluntary and precautionary action. We made the decision to take this action after extensive examination of real-world data, laboratory and track testing, and consultations with the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration.

These efforts, in conjunction with our testing and statistical analyses, have revealed that Firestone Wilderness AT tires have a significantly lower failure rate than the tires recalled last summer and that the age of the tire has a considerable impact upon its performance. However, our analyses also indicated that some Firestone Wilderness AT tires, particularly older tires (over three years), have elevated failure rates compared to other tires.

These failures include possible tire tread separation, in which the outer steel belt and/or tread of the tire separates from and may become totally detached from the rest of the tire. Tire tread separation could potentially result in loss of vehicle control and/or a crash. Because Ford does not have sufficient confidence in the future performance of these tires as they age, we're acting now in the interest of your safety to maintain your continued trust and confidence.

How this program differs from last year's recall.

Last year (Summer 2000), Firestone implemented a safety recall to replace certain 15-inch Wilderness AT and Radial ATX tires due to elevated failure rates. At the time of the Firestone recall, Ford Motor Company established an early warning system and continued to analyze real-world data to help predict tire failures before they occur.

Recent real-world data from Firestone revealed that failure rates are beginning to increase for some of the Wilderness AT tires. We view these findings as early warning signs that we cannot ignore. That is why Ford Motor Company is now voluntarily replacing all 15-, 16- and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires on Ford vehicles as a preventive measure to ensure your safety.

Firestone Tires Included in This Program

ALL WILDERNESS AT TIRES (15", 16", 17")

Affected vehicles include:

Ford Expedition
Ford Explorer,
Explorer Sport &
Explorer Sport Trac
Ford F-Series
Ford Ranger
Ford Bronco
Mercury Mountaineer

Firestone Tires Not Included in This Program

Steeltex R4S & AT on:
Ford F-Series 250+
Ford Econoline
Ford Excursion

Affinity on:
Ford Taurus
Mercury Sable
Ford Crown Victoria

Wilderness HT on:
Ford Escape
Ford Explorer,
Explorer Sport &
Explorer Sport Trac
Ford Ranger
Ford F-150

Firehawk GTA on:
Ford Focus
Mercury Cougar

Firehawk LH on:
Lincoln LS

What we are asking you to do.

Before doing anything else, check the tires that are now on your vehicle, including the spare tire. If you have Firestone Wilderness AT tires, they should be replaced. If you DO NOT have Firestone Wilderness AT tires on your vehicle, ARE NOT seeking a refund, or have changed your address, please complete and mail the enclosed postcard.

To have your tires replaced, call your Ford or Mercury Dealer or authorized tire retailer (see contact information below to obtain authorized retailer list) and request a service date for the Firestone Wilderness AT Tire Replacement Program. If you have newer Firestone Wilderness AT tires (under three years), you may be put on a waiting list, as older Wilderness AT tires will be replaced first.

You can help to further minimize the potential for any type of tire failure by keeping tires properly inflated to the recommended pressure, avoiding overloading your vehicle, and observing posted speeds. For Firestone Wilderness AT 15-inch tires on Explorer and Mountaineer model vehicles, the recommended tire pressure is 30 psi.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer (and authorized tire retailer) will do.

Your Ford or Mercury Dealer and certain authorized tire retailers will replace any Wilderness AT tires, including the spare tire, (15-, 16- and 17-inch) on your vehicle regardless of age, mileage, or whether they are original equipment tires or replacement tires free of charge.

For Tire Replacement After May 22, 2001:

If you have NOT had your tires replaced:

We recommend that you have your tires replaced at your local Ford or Mercury Dealer or authorized tire retailer with those tires indicated on the enclosed "Approved Wilderness AT Replacement Tires" list.

If you have tires replaced at non-authorized locations:

If you are (or were) unable to have your tires replaced at your Ford or Mercury Dealer or an authorized tire retailer, Ford will reimburse you:

Up to $110 for each 15-inch tire and up to $130 for each 16-inch or 17-inch tire. In order to receive reimbursement, you must go to your Ford or Mercury Dealer and provide them with:

1. Your original paid receipt.
2. The section of your replaced Firestone Wilderness AT tires that contains the DOT Code. Ask the tire dealer you purchased the tires from to cut this section of the tire from each tire replaced and provide it to you. The section must contain the entire DOT Code and be readable. Your replacement tire dealer should destroy and dispose of your removed tires and provide you with only the piece of tire with the DOT Code. The purpose of this requirement is to ensure that the replaced tires are rendered unusable and are removed from service.

Your Ford or Mercury Dealer will process and submit your refund request and forward your reimbursement check via mail.

If you had your tires replaced before May 22, 2001:

If you replaced the Wilderness AT tires on your vehicle between August 1, 2000, and May 22, 2001 (due to concerns raised by the Firestone recall of certain Wilderness AT tires announced last August), Ford will offer you a full refund with an original paid receipt.

To receive this refund, you may contact the Ford Tire Inquiry Hot Line at 1-866-300-1226 or Ford Motor Company at www.ford.com for the required reimbursement form.

If you have more concerns.

If you have trouble getting your tires replaced promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's service manager for assistance.

If you have further questions or would like to receive an updated list of replacement tires or authorized tire retailers, please call us toll-free, 24 hours a day, seven days a week at 1-866-300-1226, or e-mail us at tireinquiry@ford.com. For the latest information on-line, go to www.ford.com.

We apologize for any inconvenience this may cause you and thank you for your attention to this important matter. Maintaining your safety, your satisfaction and your trust is our top priority.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

P.O. Box 1904, Dearborn, MI 48121

Approved Wilderness AT Replacement Tires

We strongly recommend you replace your tires with those indicated on this list. These tires have met our testing and analysis requirements and have excellent on-road performance records.

RANGER APPLICATIONS

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Ranger size P215 / 75R15

Tread Design	Ford Part #	Manufacturer	Tire Brand	Speed/Load	Sidewall
AT	9002 15420750000	General	Grabber AT	100S	
AT	9001 137025783	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	100S S2	OWL TL

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Ranger size P235 / 75R15

Tread Design	Ford Part #	Manufacturer	Tire Brand	Speed/Load	Sidewall
AT	9001 137406090	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	105S S2	OWLRPTL
AT	9001 137719568	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	105S S2	OWL TL
AS	9001 727699950	Goodyear	Wrangler HT	108XL	BSL TL
AS	9001 727699952	Goodyear	Wrangler HT	108XL	OWL
AT	9001 157770009	Goodyear	Wrangler GS-A	S2	OWL
AT	9001 137441043	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	108S X2	VSB
AT	9001 137719091	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	105S S2	BSLRPTL
AT	9001 410920176	Goodyear	Wrangler AT/S	108S	OWL
AT	9004 00754	Michelin	LTX A/T	105S	ORWL
AS	9004 29394	Michelin	LTX M/S	108S	ORWL
AT	9004 90897	BFGoodrich	Long Trail T/A	108S	ORWL
AS	9004 50605	Uniroyal	Laredo Nailgard	SL 105S	ROWL
AS	9002 15446930000	Continental	ContiTrac Radial AP	XL	OWL 1.25
AT	9002 15420890000	General	Grabber AT	105S	OWL 1.00
AS	9002 1542141000	General	Grabber AP	105S	SBL 1.25
AS	9002 15421390000	General	Grabber AP	XL	SBL 1.25
AS	9002 15421400000	General	Grabber AP	XL	OWL 1.25

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Ranger size P265 / 75R15

Tread Design	Ford Part #	Manufacturer	Tire Brand	Speed/Load	Sidewall
AT	9001 137924568	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	S2	OWL TL
AT	9001 137753600	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	112S S2	BSL RP TL
AT	9002 15434550000	General	Grabber AP	SL	OWL 1.25

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Ranger size P235 / 70R16

Tread Design	Ford Part #	Manufacturer	Tire Brand	Speed/Load	Sidewall
AT	9001 137407568	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	104S S2	OWL TL
AT	9004 50373	BFGoodrich	Radial Long Trail T/A	104S	ORWL
AT	9004 96489	BFGoodrich	Radial Long Trail T/A	104S	BSW
AS	9004 59257	Michelin	LTX M/S	104S	ORWL

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Ranger size P245 / 75R16

Tread Design	Ford Part #	Manufacturer	Tire Brand	Speed/Load	Sidewall
AT	9001 137694076	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	109S S2	OWL
AT	9001 137217543	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	109S X2	OWL TL
AT	9004 59264	BFGoodrich	Radial Long Trail	109S	ORWL
AT	9004 50163	BFGoodrich	Radial Long Trail	109S	BSW

EXPLORER and MOUNTAINEER APPLICATIONS

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Explorer and Mountaineer P235 / 75R15

Tread Design	Ford Part #	Manufacturer	Tire Brand	Speed/Load	Sidewall
AT	9001 137406090	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	105S S2	OWLRPTL
AT	9001 137719568	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	105S S2	OWL TL
AS	9001 727699950	Goodyear	Wrangler HT	108XL	BSL TL
AS	9001 727699952	Goodyear	Wrangler HT	108XL	OWL
AT	9001 157770009	Goodyear	Wrangler GS-A	S2	OWL
AT	9001 137441043	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	108S X2	VSB
AT	9001 137719091	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	105S S2	BSLRPTL
AT	9001 410920176	Goodyear	Wrangler AT/S	108S	OWL
AS	9004 29394	Michelin	LTX M/S	108S	ORWL
AS	9004 57653	Michelin	LTX M/S	108S	ORBL
AS	9004 26632	Michelin	LTX M/S	105S	ORWL
AT	9004 90897	BFGoodrich	Long Trail T/A	108S	ORWL
AS	9004 50605	Uniroyal	Laredo Nailgard	SL 105S	ROWL
AS	9004 58002	Uniroyal	Laredo Nailgard	XL 108S	ROWL
AS	9002 15446930000	Continental	ContiTrac Radial AP	XL	OWL 1.25
AT	9002 15420890000	General	Grabber AT	105S	OWL 1.00
AS	9002 1542141000	General	Grabber AP	105S	SBL 1.25
AS	9002 15421390000	General	Grabber AP	XL	SBL 1.25
AS	9002 15421400000	General	Grabber AP	XL	OWL 1.25

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ONLY Explorer and Mountaineer 1991 through 1994, 1998 through 2001 size P235 / 75R15

Tread Design	*Ford Part #*	*Manufacturer*	*Tire Brand*	*Speed/Load*	*Sidewall*
AT	9004 00754	Michelin	LTX A/T	105S	ORWL
AT	9004 36544	Michelin	LTX A/T	108S	ORWL

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Explorer and Mountaineer P255 / 70R16

Tread Design	*Ford Part #*	*Manufacturer*	*Tire Brand*	*Speed/Load*	*Sidewall*
AS	9001 132840072	Goodyear	Wrangler AP	109S S2	
AT	9001 137840568	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	109S S2	OWL TL
AS	9004 39992	Michelin	LTX M/S	109S	RWL
AS	9002 15459700000	General	Ameri*660 AS	109S	OWL 1.12
AS	9002 15459870000	General	Grabber AW	109S	OWL

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ONLY Explorer and Mountaineer 1995 through 1997 size P255 / 70R16

Tread Design	*Ford Part #*	*Manufacturer*	*Tire Brand*	*Speed/Load*	*Sidewall*
AS	9004 67119	Michelin	Cross Terrain	109S	ORWL

EXPEDITION APPLICATIONS

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Expedition P255 / 70R16

Tread Design	*Ford Part #*	*Manufacturer*	*Tire Brand*	*Speed/Load*	*Sidewall*
AS	9001 132840072	Goodyear	Wrangler AP		
AT	9001 137840568	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	109S S2	OWL TL
AS	9004 67119	Michelin	Cross Terrain	109S	ORWL
AS	9002 15459870000	General	Grabber AW	109S	OWL
AS	9002 15459700000	General	Ameri*660 AS	109S	OWL 1.12

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on ALL Expedition P265 / 70R17

Tread Design	*Ford Part #*	*Manufacturer*	*Tire Brand*	*Speed/Load*	*Sidewall*
AT	9001 137930039	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	113S S2	OWL
AT	9001 137930552	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	113S S2	OWL TL
AT	9004 79964	BFGoodrich	Radial Long Trail T/A	113S	ORWL

F-SERIES and BRONCO APPLICATIONS

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on F-Series and Bronco P235 / 75R15

Tread Design	*Ford Part #*	*Manufacturer*	*Tire Brand*	*Speed/Load*	*Sidewall*
AT	9001 137058543	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	108S X2	OWL TL
AT	9001 137441043	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	108S X2	VSB
AT	9001 137441045	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	108S X2	Slanted OWL
AT	9001 137441542	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	108S X2	VSB
AT	9001 137441543	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	108S X2	Slanted OWL
AT	9001 137920783	Goodyear	Wrangler RT/S	108S X2	VSB
AS	9001 727699947	Goodyear	Wrangler HT	X2	BSL TL
AS	9001 727699950	Goodyear	Wrangler HT	108XL	BSL TL
AS	9001 727699951	Goodyear	Wrangler HT	X2	XNW TL
AS	9001 727699952	Goodyear	Wrangler HT	108XL	OWL
AS	9002 15421390000	General	Grabber AP	XL	SBL 1.25
AS	9002 15421400000	General	Grabber AP	XL	OWL 1.25
AS	9002 15434420000	General	Ameri*Way XT	108XL	OWL 1.00
AS	9002 15441280000	General	Ameri*Way XT	108XL	BSW
AS	9002 15446930000	Continental	ContiTrac Radial AP	108S	OWL
AS	9002 15458170000	Continental	ContiTrac Radial ST	108S	OWL
AS	9004 90897	BFGoodrich	Long Trail T/A	108S	ORWL

The following tires are approved replacements for Wilderness AT on 1997 F-Series P235 / 70R16

Tread Design	*Ford Part #*	*Manufacturer*	*Tire Brand*	*Speed/Load*	*Sidewall*
AT	9004 50373	BFGoodrich	Radial Long Trail T/A	104S	ORWL
AT	9004 96489	BFGoodrich	Radial Long Trail T/A	104S	BSW
AS	9002 15460150000	General	Ameri*550 AS	104S	OWL
AS	9002 15460160000	General	Ameri*550 AS	104S	BSW

Ford is continuing to test additional tires and will update the list as more tires are validated through our process. You can receive an updated list at your local dealer or at www.ford.com.